

Use foundational learning as the key

India's **struggle** with raising literacy levels **has** been **protracted** and **patchy**. But fresh data **hints at** real momentum. PLFS 2023-24 **pegs** the literacy rate (age 7+) - ability to read and write with understanding in any language - at 80.9%, a **marked** improvement from 12% in 1947. Yet, averages can **deceive**. Urban India **stands at** 88.9%, rural at 77.5%. Male **literacy** is 87.2%, but female literacy **trails at** 74.6%. **States** like Bihar, MP and Rajasthan **continue** to **lag**.

At the heart of this crisis is a **fragile** public education system. **Poor investments**, limited access and under-trained teachers **have** left millions behind. **Socioeconomic barriers** like gender discrimination **compound** the problem and lower basic learning outcomes. When children fail to acquire foundational skills - reading with meaning and solving basic maths by Class 3 - catching up becomes impossible. Yet, transformation is possible. Mizoram's **leap** to 98.2% literacy rate - **driven** by door-to-door **outreach**, community volunteers and cultural ownership - **is** proof. Targeted **campaigns** like ULLAS (Understanding of Lifelong Learning for All in Society), which targets 15+ school **dropouts** to restart their literacy journey, **show** how **coordinated** effort can deliver **remarkable** results.



But India must now treat foundational literacy and numeracy (FLN) as **non-negotiable**. Investing in FLN isn't just about schools - it's about skilling the future workforce, driving **social mobility** and unlocking economic **potential**. Without this, the **demographic dividend** could become a demographic disaster. Equally urgent is bringing back 'public' in public education. Families and communities must see themselves as co-owners of their children's learning journeys. To truly educate India, we must **push the envelope**.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.
- **Trail** (verb) – to follow or come behind

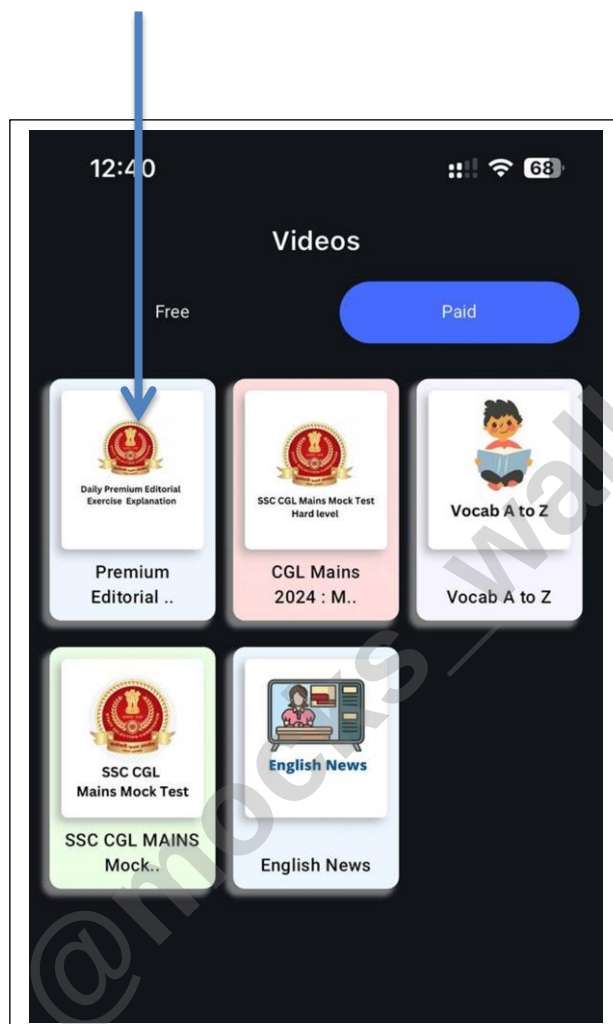
Vocabulary

1. **Protracted** (adjective) – prolonged, extended, lengthy, drawn-out, sustained
लम्बा खिंचा हुआ
2. **Patchy** (adjective) – uneven, irregular, inconsistent, spotty, scattered असंगत
3. **Hint** (at) (verb) – suggest, imply, indicate, allude, point to संकेत देना
4. **Peg** (verb) – estimate, fix, set, determine, anchor निर्धारित करना
5. **Marked** (adjective) – noticeable, significant, pronounced, evident, considerable स्पष्ट / उल्लेखनीय
6. **Deceive** (verb) – mislead, delude, trick, betray, fool धोखा देना
7. **Stand** (at) (verb) – be positioned at, amount to, total, register, measure आंकड़ा होना / दर्ज होना
8. **Literacy** (noun) – education, reading ability, writing ability, learning, knowledge साक्षरता
9. **Lag** (verb) – fall behind, trail, delay, linger, hang back पीछे रह जाना
10. **At the heart of** (phrase) – central to, core of, main part, essential element, key to मुख्य कारण / केंद्र में
11. **Fragile** (adjective) – weak, delicate, vulnerable, unstable, flimsy कमजोर
12. **Socioeconomic** (adjective) – social and economic, relating to both society and economy सामाजिक-आर्थिक
13. **Compound** (verb) – worsen, aggravate, intensify, heighten, add to और अधिक खराब करना
14. **Leap** (noun) – jump, surge, rise, boost, advance उछाल / छलांग
15. **Drive** (verb) – propel, lead, push, motivate, initiate प्रेरित करना
16. **Outreach** (noun) – engagement, contact, communication, extension, interaction जनसंपर्क / पहुंच
17. **Dropout** (noun) – school leaver, quitter, deserter, absentee, non-completer पढ़ाई छोड़ने वाला
18. **Coordinated** (adjective) – organized, synchronized, integrated, unified, planned समन्वित
19. **Remarkable** (adjective) – exceptional, outstanding, notable, extraordinary, impressive उल्लेखनीय
20. **Non-negotiable** (adjective) – fixed, uncompromisable, unchangeable, absolute, binding अनसमझौता / निश्चित

21. **Social mobility** (noun) – It refers to the shift in an individual's social status from one status to another सामाजिक गतिशीलता
22. **Potential** (noun) – possibility, capability, capacity, promise, power संभावना / क्षमता
23. **Demographic dividend** (noun) – the economic growth potential that arises when a country has a high proportion of working-age individuals compared to its dependents (children and the elderly) जनांकिकीय लाभान्श
24. **Push the envelope** (phrase) – go beyond limits, innovate, challenge norms, exceed expectations, break barriers सीमाओं से परे जाना

@mocks_wallah

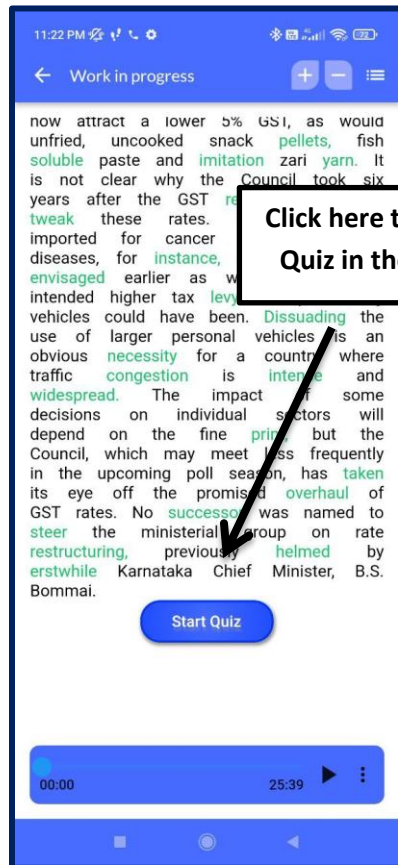
Video solution of Practice Exercise from this Editorial is exclusively available on App.



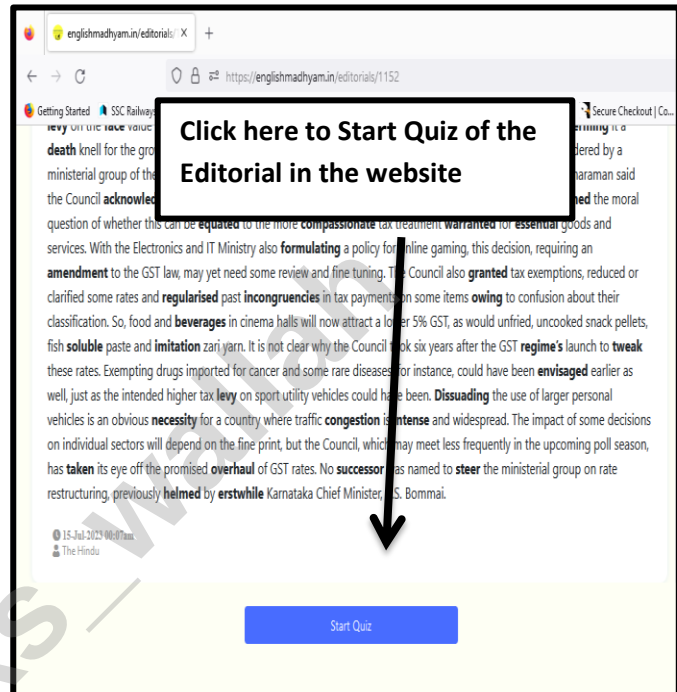
Summary of the Editorial

1. Literacy Improvement – India's literacy rate (age 7+) has improved to 80.9% in 2023-24, up from 12% in 1947.
2. Urban-Rural Gap – Literacy in urban India is 88.9%, while rural India lags at 77.5%.
3. Gender Disparity – Male literacy is 87.2%, whereas female literacy remains lower at 74.6%.
4. Regional Backlog – States like Bihar, Madhya Pradesh, and Rajasthan still have poor literacy outcomes.
5. Weak Public Education – The fragile education system, with low investment and poor teacher training, is a core issue.
6. Foundational Skills Deficit – Many children fail to acquire basic reading and math skills by Class 3, making future learning difficult.
7. Socioeconomic Barriers – Issues such as gender discrimination and poverty worsen learning gaps.
8. Mizoram's Model – Mizoram achieved 98.2% literacy through door-to-door outreach, volunteerism, and community ownership.
9. Effective Campaigns – Initiatives like ULLAS target school dropouts (15+ age group) to reignite their literacy journey.
10. FLN as a Core Goal – Foundational Literacy and Numeracy (FLN) must be made a non-negotiable national priority.
11. Broader Impact of FLN – FLN boosts not just education but also employability, social mobility, and economic growth.
12. Risk of Demographic Disaster – Without FLN, India's youth potential could become a liability, not an asset.
13. Community Involvement – Families and communities should be actively involved in children's education as co-owners.
14. Public Responsibility – India must restore faith and investment in public education, making it a shared societal mission.
15. Urgent Call to Action – To truly educate India, policy, innovation, and public participation must align to ensure foundational learning for all.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



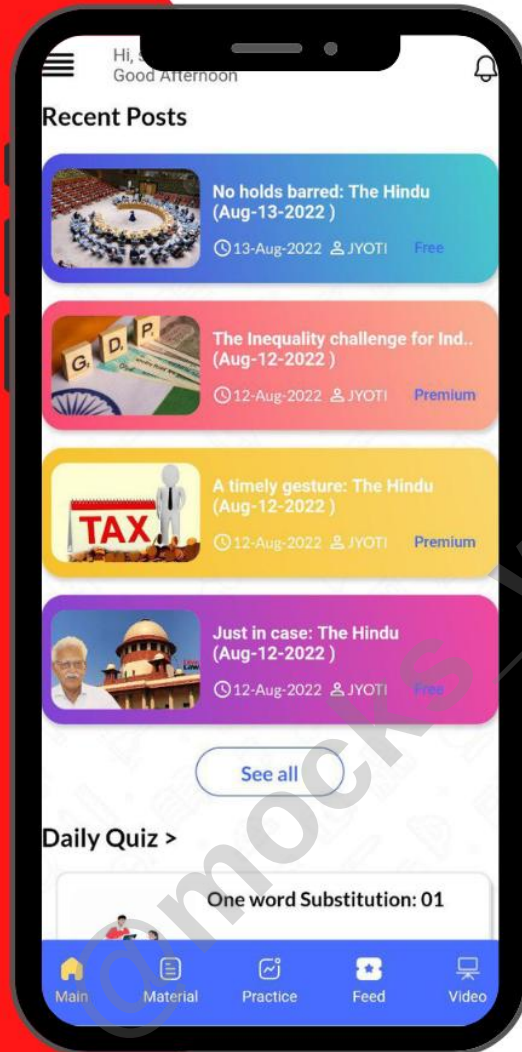
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